Lesson notes · for you

Social engineering: hacking people

Cyber security · Level 3 · Lesson 2

Time	Materials
20 min	Paper or a card, and coloured pens; A few real scam messages you've seen (names removed)

Learning goals

- Explain what social engineering is and why it works.
- Name the five tricks in calls, messages, game chats and in person.
- Respond safely: pause, check through another channel, say no.

Activity: Trick spotting

1. Collect (4 min): Write down three scam messages or calls you, your friends or your family have received or heard about. Leave out names and numbers.
2. Spot (6 min): Next to each one, name every trick it uses: authority, urgency, fear, a gift or curiosity. Most use more than one.
3. Rewrite (6 min): For each one, write the best reply, or no reply, and the other channel you would use to check.
4. Teach (4 min): Explain one example to someone at home, and ask whether they have ever received one like it.

Work with real examples, but never call back a scam number or reply to a scam message, even as a joke.

Discussion

- Why do attackers try to make you feel rushed or scared?
- How can you check a call without using the number it came from?
- When is it hard to say no, and how can you make it easier?

Check yourself

- One trick + the words I'll use to say no to it.

Try it this week

Tell someone at home about the five tricks (authority, urgency, fear, a gift, curiosity), and agree on one family rule: nobody shares a password or a code, whoever asks. If a call feels wrong, hang up and call back on a number you already know.

Worksheet

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **In a game chat, a "moderator" says your account will be banned in 10 minutes unless you confirm your password. Real or a trick?**

◯ A trick — it rushes you and wants your password ◯ Real — moderators can ban accounts

2 **Match each trick to an example.**

Authority	• • • •	"You've won 5,000 free coins!"
Urgency	• • • •	"This is the ministry's IT department."
Fear	• • • •	"Reply in the next five minutes."
A gift	• • • •	A file called "Class photos (funny)"
Curiosity	• • • •	"Your account will be deleted."

3 **If a caller knows your name, your school and your teacher's name, they must be genuine.**

◯ True ◯ False

✎ **Think of a message, call or chat that tried to rush or scare you, or someone you know. Which tricks did it use, and what would have been the best reply?**

Check your answers

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1 **A trick — it rushes you and wants your password**

Moderators can ban accounts, but they never need your password to do it.

2 **Authority — "This is the ministry's IT department."**
Urgency — "Reply in the next five minutes."
Fear — "Your account will be deleted."
A gift — "You've won 5,000 free coins!"
Curiosity — A file called "Class photos (funny)"

Naming the trick slows you down. Once you can say "that's urgency" or "that's a gift", the feeling loses its grip and you can check calmly.

3 **False**

Names and schools are easy to find on social media, in group chats and on school pages.